

Chris and Matt: A Proposal for Working Together

For Matt Campbell, from Chris Habetler. September 29, 2026. Draft for discussion.

Matt,

First, thank you for asking. I've loved working with you these last few months, and I appreciate the trust behind it.

On the 22nd you asked what I could do, what it would look like, and what I would charge. This is my stab at it. Read it as a starting point, and I expect we'll change a good bit of it together.

I'll admit I'm a little nervous putting numbers on paper. I don't want to get this wrong in either direction, so forgive anything that seems presumptuous. It only works for me if it works for you.

At a Glance

The idea	I take research, the referral network, and the day-to-day off your plate, so EdTech Expertz can take on AAP and more clients without more of your hours.
My role	Research, advisory, the referral network, and delegation
Time	About a day a week to start
Base rate	\$3,000 a month
How it grows	Up 15% of each new client's monthly retainer, plus 20% of what EdTech Expertz keeps on network deals
Start	October 1 or the day AAP signs, whichever is later
Check-ins	Weekly, a real review in January, then quarterly
Exit	30 days' notice, either of us

1. Why

The goal is to grow EdTech Expertz, in revenue and in impact. Right now the constraint is your time. You're uniquely qualified to do this work, the business is ready to grow, and nobody has a time machine. The right level and type of support, from someone you know, lets you take on AAP and more clients. This is a first step toward that.

What I'm aiming for:

- A clear working arrangement. We've both said we want to work together, and I want the terms to match.
- Helping you build EdTech Expertz into the empire you've talked about.
- The just-right level of support for this moment, adjusted as the business grows.
- A setup where you feel completely comfortable asking me for whatever you need, and I earn my place on your team.

2. What I'd Do

This is what I heard from you on the 22nd.

Area	What it includes	First month
Research	You set the goal, and I come back with more than you asked for: crosswalks, diligence readouts, prep briefs on prospective clients, and people maps that line up the right contacts inside a target organization (your "30 people at Canvas")	Prep briefs on your five parked leads

Area	What it includes	First month
Advisory	The school-side voice in your client work: first meetings with prospective clients, working sessions, messaging and language, feedback on decks and pitches, and introductions in both directions	Forward Edge on 10/1, and whatever comes up
Referral network	Recruiting members, training them on the companies, and checking in on them. Members and clients still go through you.	Member list cleaned up, one-page card on each company
Delegation	The consulting infrastructure you mentioned: the ChatGPT workspace, a shared knowledge base in Drive and the workspace, the company email, and QuickBooks	Workspace and knowledge base set up

Beyond the core, when you want them:

When	What
Worth considering	Promotional materials: one-pagers, decks, leave-behinds
Further out	Representing EdTech Expertz at conferences, working with client teams on how they serve schools, school-leader feedback panels, sales training on how schools buy, procurement help, AI enablement, L&D

If a client pays for any of this, we agree on my share before it starts.

3. How I'd Work

Mindset	I'm in this with you. Send anything that helps EdTech Expertz grow, including things neither of us has thought of yet. It's a startup. Bedtimes and family time are harder, but we'll make it work.
Response time	Same-day replies. 48 hours on requests, unless we agree otherwise.
Time	About a day a week, more in heavy weeks and less in light ones. It's a guide for what's reasonable to ask, not a limit.
Ownership	Anything I create while working with you is yours, prompts included. The one exception is work I do directly for ClassE, which falls under my own agreement with Joe.

4. The Numbers

How I Got to \$3,000

These are rough figures from our conversations that I think I have right. Please correct me where I don't.

Your business	Your monthly profit, as I understood it
Three clients (today)	About \$3,000 past your bills
Four clients (with AAP)	About \$12,000
A few more, within six months	About \$30,000

Read that way, each new client is worth roughly \$6,000 to \$9,000 a month in profit to you. \$3,000 is between a third and a half of one. The job is helping you take on and carry the next one.

How the Pay Works

Piece	Amount	How it works
Base rate	\$3,000 a month	Starts October 1 or the day AAP signs, whichever is later. The work starts when the base rate does.

Piece	Amount	How it works
New clients	+15% of each new client's monthly retainer	A \$10,000-a-month client adds \$1,500, bringing the base rate to \$4,500. Tell me the amount when a retainer signs, and I'll invoice the new number.
Referral network	20% of what EdTech Expertz keeps on network deals	Your 9/16 idea: pay that "grows as the sales these individuals bring in grows." I'll never pitch members, and my own intros stay under our August agreement.
Projects, courses, speaking	Agreed before each one starts	Only if I help build it
Already in motion	No charge	Benchmark, and Forward Edge on 10/1

Why these percentages:

- 15% is the top of the 10% to 15% range referral partners typically earn on new business. It leaves 85% of every new client with EdTech Expertz.
- 20% is higher because it applies only to network deals, which I'd be running day to day. I don't know what you usually keep on a network deal, so this is the number most likely to change.

If this is too big a swing to start, let's find a smaller one. From what I understand, you could use the support, and I sure wouldn't mind a little income.

5. Check-Ins and Changes

This is meant to be ongoing, not a trial.

When	What happens
Every week	A short check-in where you set the priorities
January	Our first real review: what I delivered, what it freed up for you, and whether the rate and the time still match the work
After that	Quarterly, or anytime either of us wants

If	Then
The work runs well past a day a week for a month or two	We look at the base rate together
You sign a very large client	We reset the rate and the role together
A client leaves, or AAP slips past October	We talk at the next check-in, rather than letting a formula decide
You bring on more people	We work out my new role together
Either of us wants out	30 days' notice, the notice month is paid, and you get a clean handoff. The network share keeps paying for 12 months on deals already logged.

6. Items for Conversation

1. A full-time role. I'm in late rounds for a full-time role at a charter network, and there may be others. If one happens, you'll hear it from me first, and I want to keep doing both, with the work before and after the school day. We'd work out timing, since the network check-ins are most tied to the school day, and anything a school employer would want to clear, since the network puts vendors in front of schools.

2. Your numbers. Do I have the profit picture above right?
3. What you usually keep on a network deal. That tells us whether 20% is right.
4. How many hours a week research and the network take you now.
5. The ClassE advisory. You asked on 9/16 what I'd need. Joe would pay it directly, so it doesn't touch your ClassE fee or count toward my 15%. My starting thought is \$3,000 a month, and I'd want your read on how to frame it with Joe and where that work ends and my work for you begins.

Thank you again for asking. I'm looking forward to talking it through and figuring out what works best for you. Clarity is king, so push on any of it.

Chris